

Case Study: (Candidate Assessment)

Company Background:

AlliedOne Limited (AOL) is a newly formed technology company based in Dhaka, operating as a sister concern of an established international trade business. AOL was founded this year to build out IT/digital ventures, including:

- 1) An educational app/web platform for SSC/HSC and university-admission students
- 2) Different AI Training Programs
- 3) Digital Marketing Services
- 4) A planned second phase of app/software product development

AOL currently has a small team consisting of two BUET & RUET (Stack Developer) and a third-year IBA student supporting business/strategy tasks. All three work part-time (5 hours/day, 5 days/week) and have no prior professional work experiences. They are capable but need clear technical and strategic direction.

👉 Role:

The CTO will be the primary technical and product decision-maker at AOL, working closely with the founder. Core responsibilities include:

- 1) Deciding which products/services to prioritize and when to launch them, based on market opportunity, feasibility, and team capacity.
- 2) Identifying the dependencies, logistics, and stakeholders needed to bring a product/service to market, and communicating resource/budget needs to the founder.
- 3) Running a pilot-first approach — launching small, identifying problems, iterating, then scaling to full commercial launch.
- 4) Leading and directing the existing part-time team, assigning tasks appropriately given their inexperience, and following up to ensure consistent delivery.
- 5) Tracking revenue performance against projections, and flagging/acting quickly when there's a significant gap between expected and actual results.
- 6) Continuously generating new product/service ideas while also managing day-to-day technical operations.

👉 Case Scenario:

AOL has three potential first products to choose from:

- 1) **Product A:** An SSC/HSC exam-prep mobile app (quizzes, video content, mock tests)

2) **Product B:** A basic e-commerce storefront for a partner business, with digital marketing services

3) **Product C:** Different Trainings e.g. AI, Prompt engineering, Cyber Security, Basic MS office fundamentals Export-Import Trainings etc.

Resources available:

3 part-time team members (as described above), 5 hrs/day, 5 days/week

A modest initial budget (to be estimated by you)

No existing user base or brand recognition yet

Founder available for business decisions but not hands-on technical direction

Target: visible traction and initial revenue within approximately 6 months

 Questions:

1) **Prioritization**

Which of the three products would you launch first, and why? What criteria did you use to decide?

2) **Dependencies & Logistics**

What are the top 5 dependencies, resources, or external stakeholders you'd need to secure before this product can launch (e.g., content, hosting, payment gateway, partnerships, legal, marketing channels)?

3) **Budget & Team Plan**

Give a rough budget estimate for the first 3 months, and how you'd divide the current 3-person team's time across tasks. Be specific about what you'd personally do vs. delegate.

4) **Pilot → Commercial Launch**

Describe how you'd structure a pilot phase — what would you test, how would you measure success, and what would trigger moving to full commercial launch?

5) **Revenue Gap Response**

Suppose after 3 months, actual revenue is 60% below what was projected. Walk through how you'd diagnose the cause and what your first two actions would be.